

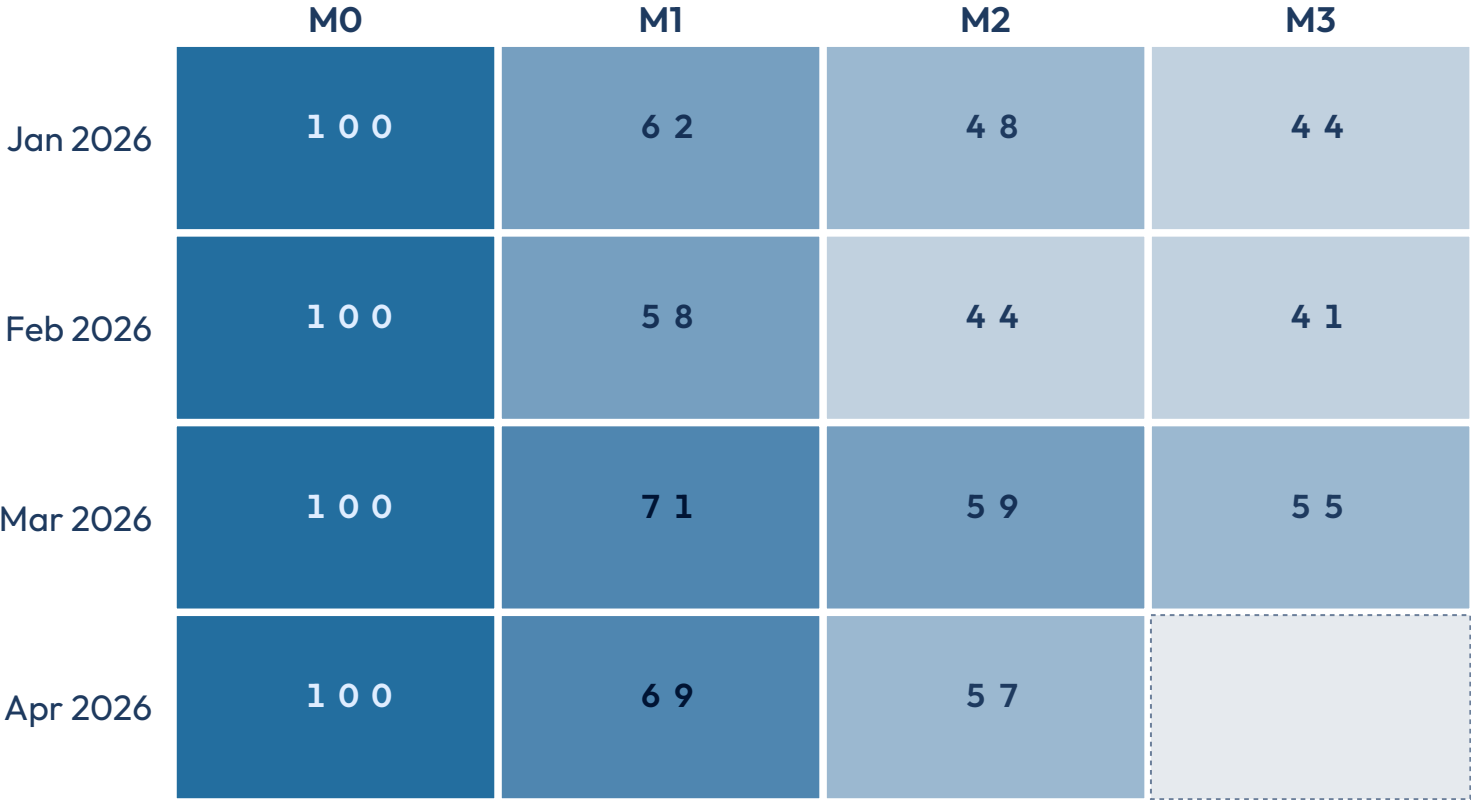
EVIDENCE • CANVAS • SERIES

# heatmap

A numeric matrix read as intensity — where the value concentrates across two dimensions.

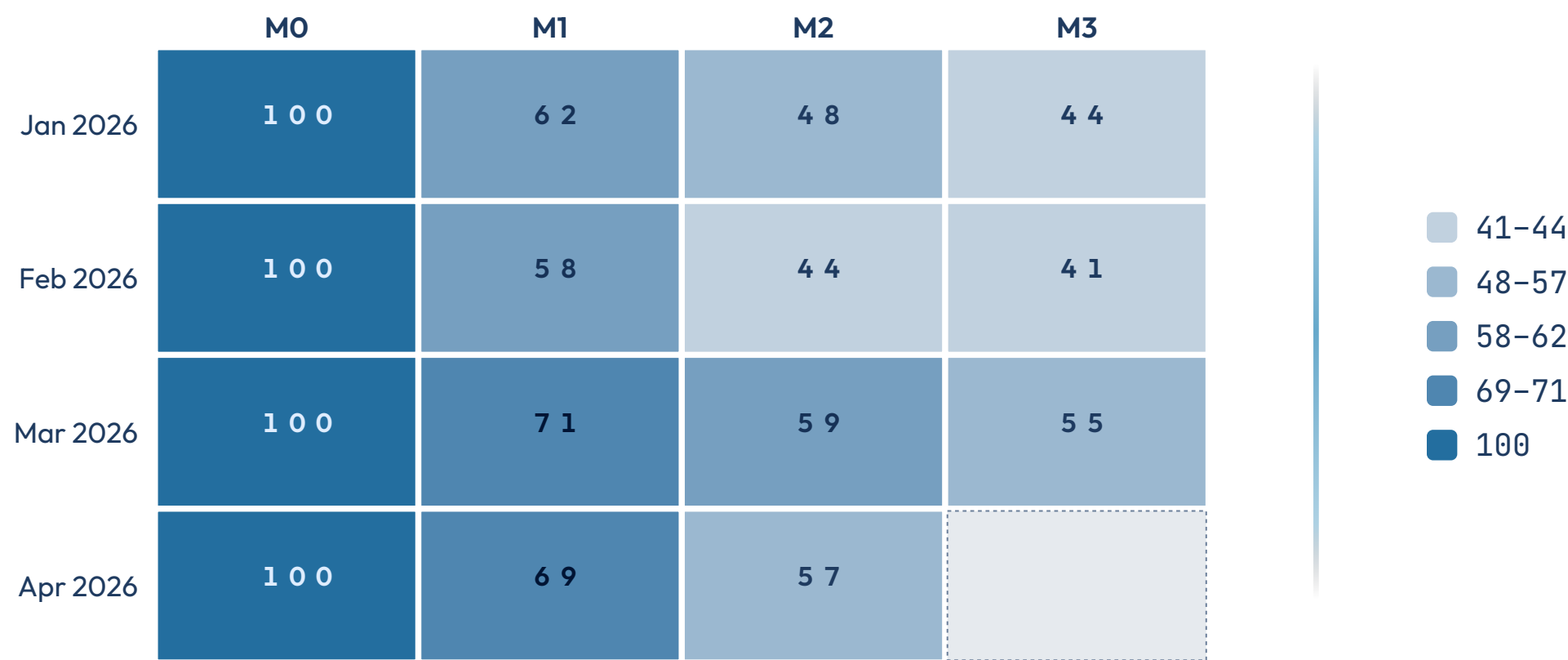
RETENTION · 2026 COHORTS

# Retention decays fastest in month two.



RETENTION · 2026 COHORTS

# The chart names its own bands.

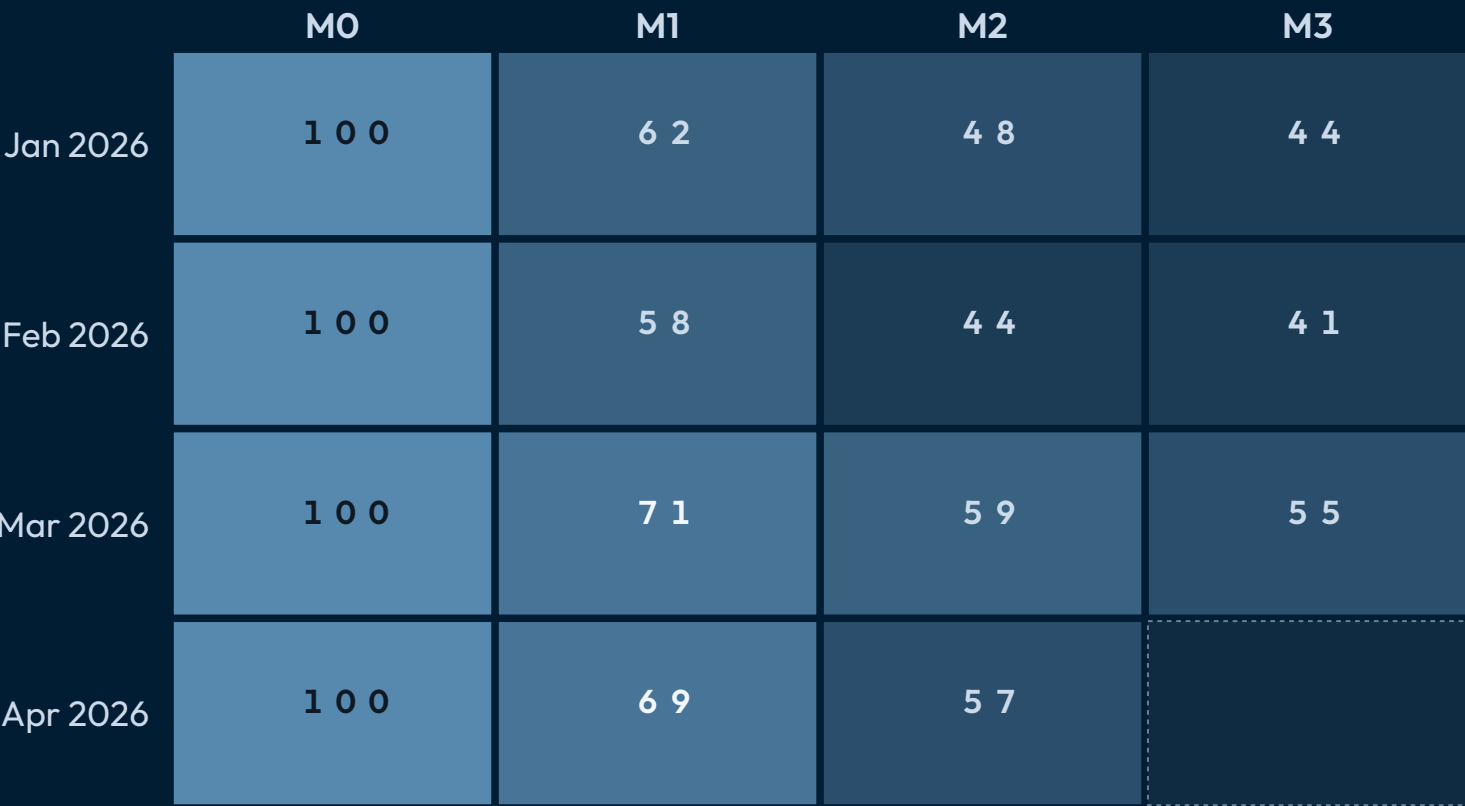


RETENTION · THE CEILING

Ten cohorts by twelve months — the density this holds.

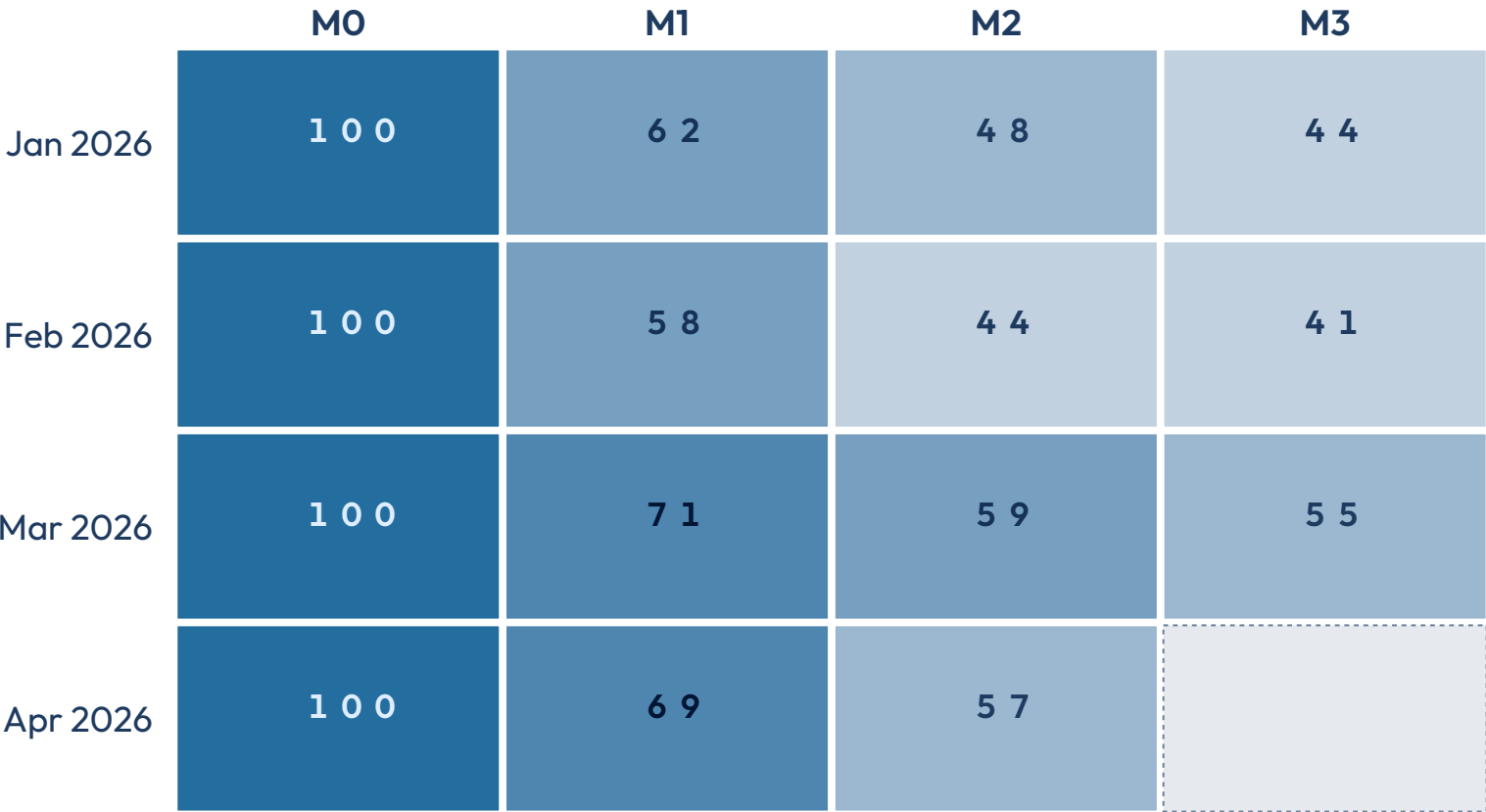
|                 | M0        | M1  | M2  | M3  | M4  | M5  | M6  | M7  | M8  | M9  | M10 | M11 |
|-----------------|-----------|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|
| January 2026... | 1 0 0 7 1 | 5 9 | 5 5 | 5 2 | 5 0 | 4 8 | 4 7 | 4 6 | 4 5 | 4 4 | 4 3 |     |
| February 2026   | 1 0 0 5 8 | 4 4 | 4 1 | 3 9 | 3 8 | 3 7 | 3 6 | 3 5 | 3 4 | 3 3 | 3 2 |     |
| March 2026      | 1 0 0 6 2 | 4 8 | 4 5 | 4 3 | 4 2 | 4 1 | 4 0 | 3 9 | 3 8 | 3 7 |     |     |
| April 2026      | 1 0 0 6 9 | 5 7 | 5 4 | 5 1 | 4 9 | 4 8 | 4 7 | 4 6 | 4 5 |     |     |     |
| May 2026        | 1 0 0 6 6 | 5 4 | 5 0 | 4 8 | 4 7 | 4 6 | 4 5 | 4 4 |     |     |     |     |
| June 2026       | 1 0 0 6 4 | 5 2 | 4 9 | 4 7 | 4 6 | 4 5 | 4 4 |     |     |     |     |     |
| July 2026       | 1 0 0 6 1 | 5 0 | 4 7 | 4 5 | 4 4 | 4 3 |     |     |     |     |     |     |
| August 2026     | 1 0 0 5 9 | 4 8 | 4 5 | 4 3 | 4 2 |     |     |     |     |     |     |     |
| September 2026  | 1 0 0 5 7 | 4 7 | 4 4 | 4 2 |     |     |     |     |     |     |     |     |
| October 2026    | 5 5       | 5 5 | 5 5 | 5 5 |     |     |     |     |     |     |     |     |

# Retention decays fastest in month two.



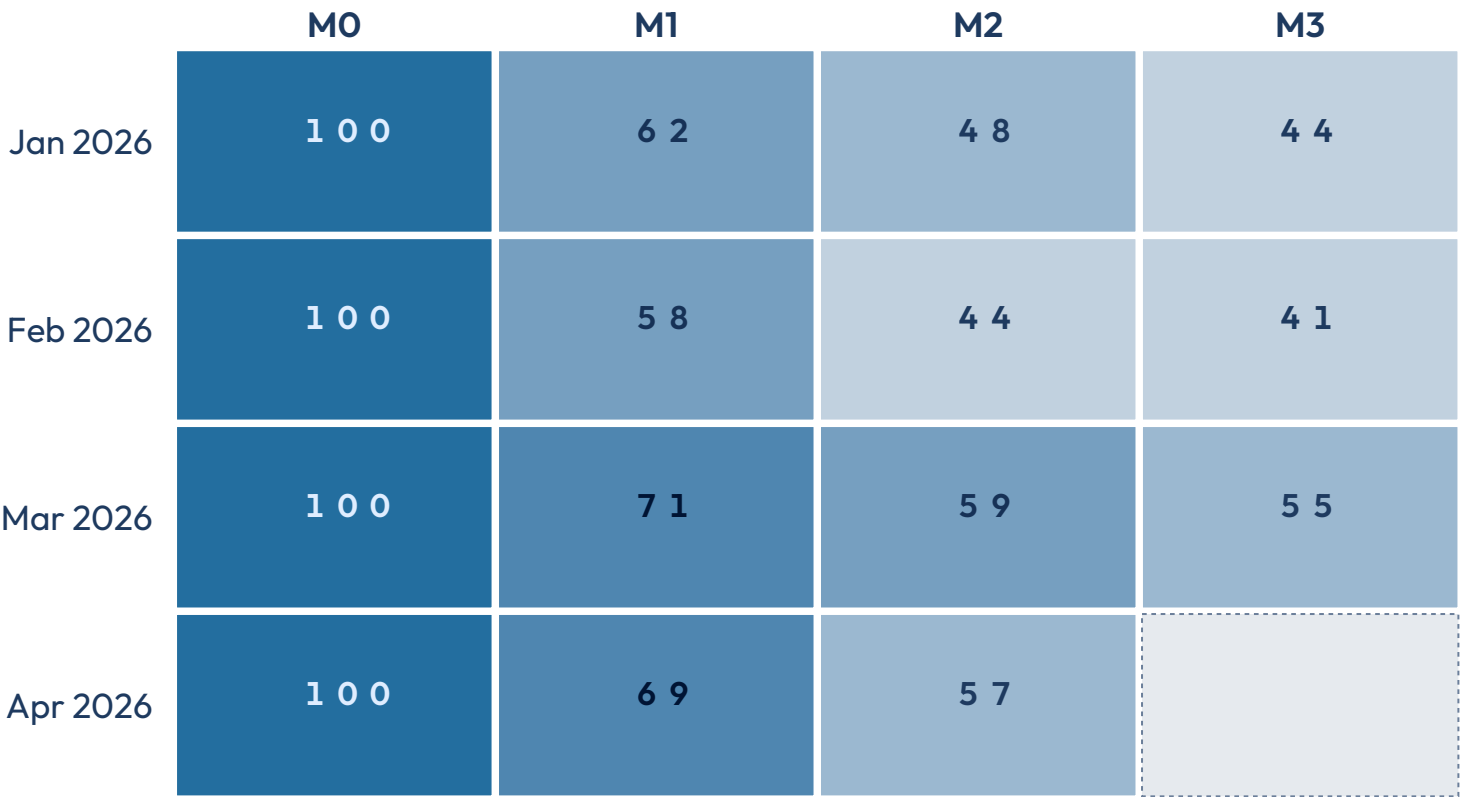
RETENTION · 2026 COHORTS

# Retention decays fastest in month two.



RETENTION • 2026 COHORTS

# Retention decays fastest in month two.



# When NOT to reach for heatmap.

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## One row of numbers

A single series is not a matrix — it is a comparison, and a reader judges length far more precisely than intensity. Use `bar`. The kernel declines a one-column table for this reason rather than painting a single strip.

## Qualitative cells

If the cells are verbs, owners or statuses rather than numbers, the ramp has nothing to encode. Use `matrix-grid`, whose cells are tagged at parse time.

# When NOT to reach for heatmap.

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## Precise comparison

Asking a reader which of two similar cells is larger spends the one thing intensity is bad at, and the five-tone binning above makes it stricter: two cells in the same band are the same color by design. If the comparison has to be exact, the value belongs on an axis — `bar` or `line`.

## Geography

A value per country or region belongs on the `map` choropleth, which shares this ramp but places the cells where the reader expects them.

## RELATED COMPONENTS

# See also.

`matrix-grid` — the cells are qualitative — a verb, an owner, a status — rather than a number

`map` — the two dimensions are geographic; same ramp, spatial placement

`bar` — one dimension, and the comparison has to be exact

`quadrant` — two CONTINUOUS axes with items placed on them, rather than two categorical axes with a value at each crossing